

04-22-2025 MCS Board Meeting

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ZKwoPBjX_mQ
Publication Date	2025-04-23T10:19:26Z
Target Category	mcs

Notice: This report is provided by the [Muncie Policy Memo](#) as a public service. This summary is generated automatically using artificial intelligence from public video transcripts, both of which are prone to error. The report is intended to provide an overview of meeting business and an aid to accessing detailed information from the video recording. When accuracy is critical, please refer to the official video recording or approved minutes.

Municipal Meeting Summary Report

Meeting Date & Context: Regular School Board Meeting (Exact date referenced in transcript as 2025; state championship and financial estimates reflect 2025 planning).

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The presiding officer called the meeting to order [00:01:55](#), followed by a moment of silence and the Pledge of Allegiance [00:02:17](#).
- **Attendance:**
 - **Present:** Dr. Washbourne, Mr. Heater, Mr. Irvin, Mr. L., Mr. Williams (Presiding Officer), and Mrs. Barnes Griffin (joined remotely).
 - **Absent:** Dr. O'Neal (out of town).

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:**
 - The board welcomed the award-winning MCHS Percussion ensemble [00:02:53](#), who recently secured first place as Indiana Percussion Association state champions for their class division [00:03:15](#).

- A spotlight presentation was delivered by the administrative team from Southside Middle School (SMS), detailing school turnaround efforts, data-tracking methods, and student engagement initiatives [00:09:46](#). Three student representatives (Crystal Flores, Dalen Curtis, and Cameron Dabney) also addressed the board [00:38:39](#).
 - **Approval of Minutes:** Prior meeting minutes and procedural items under the consent agenda (including personnel recommendations such as the appointment of Dean Hayes) were approved by roll call vote following procedural re-opening [00:54:11](#).
-

4. Substantive Business & Board Action

[00:53:33](#) Financial Report (Month of March)

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Derome, Chief Financial Officer.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Mr. Derome presented the March financial update. Key highlights included:
 - The state basic grant estimate for calendar year 2025 remains budgeted at approximately \$47.3 million while the state legislature continues budget debates.
 - The district maintains over \$35 million in its checkbook and continues paying down its state loan, reducing the balance to \$7.3 million.
 - The education fund is projected to end 2025 over \$15.5 million. No long-term debt payments occurred in March.
 - Staff are actively reviewing simulations and potential impacts of emerging state legislation (such as Senate Bill 1) on operational funds.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by formal roll call vote (unanimous among participating members) [00:58:00](#).
-

[00:58:10](#) Statutory Public Hearing: Proposed Construction Projects & Financing

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Derome, Chief Financial Officer.
- **Deliberation Summary:**
 - Mr. Derome opened the statutory first public hearing regarding proposed capital construction projects totaling approximately \$19 million.
 - Identified capital needs include: replacing the failed boiler and HVAC system at the Muncie Fieldhouse (currently operating on a temporary rental boiler); chiller replacement and bleacher repairs at North Side Middle School; lower arena bleacher replacement (40+ years old) at the Fieldhouse; replacement of 18 exterior door sets (over 50 doors total) at Muncie Central High School for security upgrades; over 50,000 square feet of flat roofing replacements across various district schools; and

resurfacing tracks and tennis courts at Southside Middle School and Muncie Central High School.

- Financing, structured in partnership with Baker Tilly, proposes a combination of lease rental bonds (~\$10 million over 15 years) and general obligation bonds (~\$9.8 million paid off over 2 years). The structure is designed to maintain tax neutrality by keeping the existing debt service tax rate steady at 41 cents for two years before dropping to an estimated 16 cents, while preserving future district borrowing capacity.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** Presiding officer called for public comments on the capital projects; no members of the public stepped forward to speak [00:12:38](#).
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Public hearing formally closed [00:13:19](#). No final board vote or adoption is legally required or executed at this first preliminary hearing stage.

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- No general public comments were recorded during the open citizen forum portion of the meeting.

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - Dr. Reynolds reported successful kindergarten kickoff events with enrollment numbers up nearly 40 students compared to prior years; open enrollment remains active [00:48:21](#).
 - Standardized I-LEARN testing is currently underway across district schools [00:49:04](#).
 - Summer school programs are posted and open for registration [00:49:34](#).
 - The annual "Celebrate Excellence" Art Show is scheduled for May 15th at the Fieldhouse [00:51:25](#).
 - Upcoming athletic events include the historic Muncie Relays track meet on Saturday [00:49:49](#).
- **Adjournment:** Following final roll call verifications for prior agenda items, the meeting was officially adjourned [01:06:09](#).